

Lean — Onboarding and Personalisation Review

HubX · TapSuite Studio

Independent user review · September 2026 · Android

1. Purpose and scope

This is an independent review of Lean's flow from install through first use. It draws only on public sources: the released app, the Google Play listing, Lean's "Sources of Recommendations" page, and the Terms of Use. No internal data was accessed.

Two questions guided the work. First, does the app's actual behaviour match what Lean publishes about it? Second, where in the onboarding flow does the product lose value it could keep?

2. Method

I uninstalled and reinstalled the app and completed onboarding four times, changing one variable per run and holding everything else constant. Comparisons are based on the calorie and macro figures shown on the final "Daily recommendation" screen.

Held constant:

- Height 163 cm · Weight 66 kg · Target weight 60 kg
- Target loss 0.5 kg per week · 3-5 workouts per week
- Goal: lose weight · Intermittent fasting: not interested

Varied: gender (Female / Male / Other) and diet type (High protein / Nothing special).

Document comparisons were made across three official texts accessed on the same date: the Play listing, the sources page, and the Terms of Use.

3. Evidence levels

These findings rest on different kinds of evidence, so each one is labelled:

- Controlled test — a repeatable measurement, documented with screenshots.
- Document comparison — two of the company's own published texts placed side by side.
- Observation — noted from the flow, not backed by measurement.
- Hypothesis — consistent with what I could see, but needs internal data to confirm.

4. Findings

Finding 1 — Selecting "Other" silently applies the male formula

Evidence: Controlled test · **Severity:** High

Gender	Calories	Protein	Carbs	Fat
Female	1758	154 g	154 g	59 g
Male	2008	176 g	176 g	67 g
Other	2008	176 g	176 g	67 g

With identical height, weight, age, goal and activity inputs, choosing "Other" produces exactly the same plan as choosing "Male" — a difference of 250 kcal per day, or roughly 14%, against the female result.

The sources page publishes only two Harris-Benedict variants, female and male. Nothing explains which coefficients apply to the third option. The product makes that choice and does not tell the user.

The consequence: a user with female physiology who selects "Other" starts with a daily target well above her actual requirement, with no way to notice it. Following the plan exactly will not produce the promised result.

Finding 2 — The diabetes claim in the store listing contradicts the binding terms

Evidence: Document comparison • **Severity:** High

The Play listing states that the app helps support diabetes and blood sugar control. Against that:

- Terms of Use, 6.2 and 9.3: the app is not a medical product, treatment or cure, and does not diagnose, treat or prevent any disease or medical condition.
- Terms of Use, 5.2: the stated purpose is calorie and nutrition tracking, weight progress and intermittent fasting. Condition management is not among them.
- Sources page: names diabetes explicitly among conditions for which the app offers no specific guidance.

Under clause 1.3 the Terms of Use are a binding agreement between HubX and the user. The conflict is therefore not between two pieces of marketing copy but between a binding contract and a public product claim.

The reasoning behind the claim is defensible — carbohydrate tracking genuinely helps with blood sugar management. The problem is not the claim itself but that two official texts say opposite things about the same group of users. Google Play's Health Content and Services policy prohibits misleading health functionality, and apps focused on managing chronic conditions such as diabetes form their own category in the Play Console health apps declaration. This wording triggers a classification, not just a marketing question.

Finding 3 — Efficacy claims carry no sources

Evidence: Document comparison • **Severity:** Medium

Three consecutive onboarding screens make numerical claims: twice the weight loss compared with other apps, 91% of users reporting visible change, 82% maintaining their progress after six months. None cites a source, study or sample.

This sits oddly beside the product's own standard. For BMR and macros, Lean maintains a separate sources page citing the CDC, the WHO and a peer-reviewed ESPEN publication. That rigour stops at the persuasion screens.

For the Turkish market specifically: advertising regulation places the burden of proof on the advertiser and requires verifiable factual claims to be supported by scientifically valid documentation. Comparative advertising is held to a stricter standard still, requiring documentation from university departments or accredited independent testing bodies. "Twice as much as other apps" is a comparative claim.

The "x2" chart also mixes its units: one bar is labelled as a percentage (20%), the other as a multiplier (x2), and the bar heights match neither.

Finding 4 — Diet type pushes macros outside the published range

Evidence: Controlled test • **Severity:** Medium

Scenario	Calories	Protein	Carbs	Fat
Published range	—	25-35%	40-50%	20-30%
Nothing special	2008	25%	50%	25%
High protein	2008	35%	35%	30%

On the default diet type all three macros fall inside the published ranges. Selecting "High protein" drops carbohydrates to 35%, below the published 40-50% band.

The behaviour itself is reasonable — ratios should shift with diet type. The gap is that the sources page publishes a single fixed ratio and never mentions the deviation. For a product that documents its methodology this carefully, that is a documentation gap worth closing.

Finding 5 — Store assets are Turkish, the app is entirely English

Evidence: Observation • **Severity:** Medium

The Play listing's title, description and screenshots are in Turkish. Across four installs, the app interface — onboarding, results screen and paywall included — appeared entirely in English.

Prices display in Turkish lira, so the localisation infrastructure exists; what is missing is the content translation. An untranslated paywall sits exactly where the purchase decision is made, which makes this a measurable conversion cost rather than a cosmetic issue.

Google Play's metadata policy requires the description, title and screenshots to represent the app accurately. The gap here is between store assets and the product, not simply a missing translation.

5. Additional observations

None of the following were verified by measurement.

- Rating distribution (Observation): across 1,068 ratings the distribution is bimodal — a dominant 5-star block, a clear 1-star cluster, and almost nothing at 4 or 2 stars. Most ratings carry no written review. This pattern is typical of ratings driven by an in-app prompt.
- Prompt timing (Hypothesis): the rating prompt appears mid-onboarding, before the user has logged a single meal, and is followed immediately by the paywall. That sequence plausibly depresses the average rating, but confirming it needs prompt impression and response data.
- Paywall placement (Observation): it appears before the user has seen any value from the product, and the screen does not list what a subscription unlocks.
- Notification permission screen (Observation): the sample notification shown is an intermittent fasting reminder, even for a user who declined interest in fasting a few screens earlier. Most likely a static asset rather than a bug — but a missed personalisation opportunity on the screen that determines permission rates.
- Weight projection chart (Observation): the curve steepens towards the end, implying the fastest loss comes last. The app's own date arithmetic assumes a constant weekly rate ($6\text{ kg} \div 0.5\text{ kg/week} = 12\text{ weeks}$, 1 December). The maths is right; the visual tells a different story.
- "Health Score" (Observation): store screenshots show a score out of ten. While BMR, BMI and macro ratios are documented in detail, I found no explanation of how this score is calculated.
- Worth noting on the positive side: the weekly loss rate selector spans 0.1-1.5 kg and defaults to 0.5 kg — anchored to the moderate end rather than the aggressive one.

6. Recommendations and measurement plan

Area	Recommended action	Metric to watch
Finding 1	Ask a follow-up question when "Other" is selected; alternatively, state the applied default clearly and make it changeable in settings.	Goal completion rate by segment, 30-day retention, refund rate
Finding 2	Narrow the store wording to what the product actually does, or align it with the sources page and Terms of Use.	Policy warnings; installs and refunds from the related keywords
Finding 3	Substantiate the claims or replace them with measurable statements; fix the unit mismatch in the x2 chart.	Onboarding completion rate, drop-off by screen
Finding 4	Extend the sources page to cover per-diet-type ratio ranges.	Support ticket volume (plan/methodology category)
Finding 5	Translate in-app copy, starting with the paywall and onboarding.	paywall_view → subscribe conversion in the TR segment, D1 retention
Rating prompt	Move the prompt to after the first logged meal.	Average rating, share of 1-2 star ratings, response rate per prompt

7. References

- Google Play — Health Content and Services policy and Health apps declaration requirements (Play Console Help).
- Google Play — Metadata policy (accuracy of description, title and screenshots).
- Turkish Regulation on Commercial Advertising and Unfair Commercial Practices — burden of proof and comparative advertising provisions; enforced by the Advertisement Board.
- Lean — "Sources of Recommendations" page (Harris-Benedict, BMI, macro ratios).
- Lean — Terms of Use, clauses 1.3, 5.2, 6.2, 9.3.

8. Limitations

- All tests ran on a single Android device with a single user profile. Results may differ by country, language, platform or experiment group.
- Active A/B tests may have shaped the flow I saw; these findings reflect one variant.
- References to regulation and platform policy quote those texts as written and do not constitute legal assessment.
- Recommendations rest only on externally observable information. Without access to the data the product team used, some of these decisions may well be deliberate and already tested.